

Kuri Macye — 100% Readiness Roadmap

Overview

Phase	Timeline	Focus	Score target
Phase 1 — Foundation	Weeks 1-4	Critical blockers	50 → 70
Phase 2 — Operations	Weeks 5-10	Payments, logistics, trust	70 → 85
Phase 3 — Growth	Weeks 11-16	SEO, marketing, analytics	85 → 95
Phase 4 — Scale	Month 5+	Automation, legal, partnerships	95 → 100

Phase 1 — Fix the foundation (Weeks 1-4) • +20 pts

1.1 Fix SEO & crawlability (Critical)

- **Problem:** Site is a JavaScript-only SPA — Google cannot index any page.
- **Solution:** Implement Server-Side Rendering (SSR) using Next.js, or add pre-rendering (e.g. via Prerender.io).
- **Impact:** Google can now find and rank your product pages.
- **Who:** Frontend developer, 1-2 weeks.

1.2 Fix mobile experience

- **Problem:** Rwanda is 90%+ mobile. A sluggish or unoptimized mobile experience kills conversions.

- **Solution:** Run Lighthouse audit, compress images, lazy-load below-fold content, test on low-end Android devices (Tecno, Itel).
- **Impact:** Faster load = more buyers staying on site.
- **Who:** Frontend developer, 1 week.

1.3 Add essential legal pages

- Terms & Conditions
- Privacy Policy (required by Rwanda's Data Protection Law)
- Refund & Returns Policy
- Vendor Agreement (contract for sellers)
- **Who:** Legal advisor or use a Rwanda-specific template, 1 week.

1.4 Set up basic analytics

- Install Google Analytics 4 and Google Search Console.
 - Set up conversion tracking (product views → add to cart → purchase).
 - **Who:** Developer, 2 days.
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Phase 2 — Build the operational backbone (Weeks 5-10) • +15 pts

2.1 Integrate MTN MoMo & Airtel Money (Non-negotiable)

- **Why:** 80%+ of Rwandans use mobile money. Without this, no one can pay.
- **How:**
 - Apply for MTN MoMo merchant account at mtn.co.rw/momo-business
 - Apply for Airtel Money merchant API
 - Alternatively, integrate via a payment aggregator like **Flutterwave Rwanda**, **DPO Pay**, or **Pesapal** — these handle both MoMo and card in one SDK.

- Add card payments (Visa/Mastercard) via DPO Pay for urban buyers.
- **Who:** Backend developer, 2-3 weeks.

2.2 Build a real vendor dashboard

Every seller needs:

- ☐ Product listing tool (photos, description, price, stock)
- ☐ Order management (view orders, mark as shipped)
- ☐ Earnings & payout tracker (when do they get paid?)
- ☐ Notification system (new order alerts via SMS or WhatsApp)

Who: Full-stack developer, 3-4 weeks.

2.3 Vendor verification & onboarding

- Require National ID or RDB registration number for business sellers.
- Build a simple approval workflow (submit docs → admin reviews → approved/rejected).
- Show a "Verified Seller" badge on approved stores.
- **Who:** Developer + admin team, 1-2 weeks.

2.4 Delivery / logistics integration

Option A — Partner with an existing service:

- Yego Moto (motorcycle delivery, Kigali)
- SafeMotos / Bolt Food logistics
- Rwanda Post (national coverage)

Option B — Build a lightweight system:

- Seller ships to a central Kuri Macye collection point.

- Buyer picks up or requests delivery.

Option C — Hybrid:

- In Kigali: partner delivery within 24h.
- Outside Kigali: bus transport / Rwanda Post, 2-5 days.

At minimum, buyers must see an estimated delivery time and cost at checkout.

2.5 Ratings & review system

- After order completion, buyer gets prompted to rate seller (1-5 stars) and leave a review.
 - Display average rating on every seller store and product page.
 - Flag sellers with rating < 3.0 for admin review.
 - **Why:** Trust is the #1 barrier for e-commerce in Rwanda.
 - **Who:** Developer, 1-2 weeks.
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Phase 3 — Growth engine (Weeks 11-16) • +10 pts

3.1 SEO content strategy

- Write dedicated landing pages for top categories: electronics, fashion, home goods, food, services.
- Add product schema markup (structured data) so Google shows prices in search results.
- Target keywords like "buy online Rwanda", "online shopping Kigali", "vendeur en ligne Rwanda".

3.2 WhatsApp Business integration

- Add "Chat with seller" button on every product page (links to seller's WhatsApp).
- Set up a Kuri Macye support WhatsApp number for buyer disputes.
- Why: Rwandans heavily use WhatsApp for commerce — meet buyers where they already are.

3.3 Vendor acquisition campaign

- Visit Kimironko Market, Nyabugogo, and Remera market.
- Offer free vendor registration for the first 6 months.
- Run a "first 100 vendors" campaign with zero commission on sales.
- Partner with RDB (Rwanda Development Board) for visibility.

3.4 Social media & influencer marketing

- TikTok & Instagram: product showcases, vendor stories, unboxings.
- Partner with 5-10 Rwandan micro-influencers (5k-50k followers).
- Run "Gura kuri Macye" (Buy on Kuri Macye) hashtag campaign.

3.5 Referral program

- Buyers get RWF 2,000 credit for each friend they refer who makes a purchase.
- Sellers get 1 month free of premium listing for referring another seller.

Phase 4 — Scale & solidify (Month 5+) • +5 pts

4.1 Dispute resolution system

- Build a formal claim process: buyer raises dispute → seller has 48h to respond → admin mediates.

- Define clear refund timelines (e.g. 5 business days).
- Integrate with Rwanda Consumer Protection.

4.2 Commission & monetization model

Suggested model:

- 0% commission — months 1-6 (growth phase)
- 5% commission on sales — from month 7
- Premium seller plans (featured listings, analytics, ads) — RWF 15,000-50,000/month

4.3 Admin dashboard & fraud prevention

- Build internal admin panel: manage vendors, review flags, process disputes.
- Add basic fraud detection: flag accounts with abnormal order patterns.
- Implement OTP verification for all accounts (phone number required).

4.4 Expand beyond Kigali

- Onboard sellers in Musanze, Huye, Rubavu, Nyagatare.
- Add Kinyarwanda language option (full translation of the platform).
- Partner with district offices to promote digital commerce outside Kigali.

4.5 Performance & uptime

- Move to a production-grade hosting environment (Vercel, AWS, or Render).
 - Set up uptime monitoring (e.g. UptimeRobot).
 - Implement a CDN (Cloudflare free tier) for faster load times in Rwanda.
 - Target: 99.5%+ uptime, < 3 second load time on 3G.
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Score tracker

Dimension	Now	After Phase 1	After Phase 2	After Phase 3	After Phase 4
Design & UX	70	80	85	90	95
Payments	50	55	95	95	100
Logistics	50	50	85	90	95
Trust & safety	30	45	75	85	100
Vendor tools	40	45	85	90	100
Tech infra	60	80	85	90	100
Legal	30	75	80	85	100
Marketing	—	—	—	85	95
Overall	50	66	84	89	~98

Recommended team to hire / contract

Role	Type	Priority
Full-stack developer (Next.js / Node.js)	Hire or freelance	Immediate
Mobile Money integration specialist	Freelance	Immediate
UI/UX designer	Freelance	Phase 1

Role	Type	Priority
Content writer (EN + Kinyarwanda)	Part-time	Phase 3
Operations manager (logistics, vendors)	Hire	Phase 2
Legal advisor (Rwanda law)	Consult	Phase 1

Estimated budget (RWF)

Item	Estimated cost
SSR / Next.js migration	500,000 - 1,500,000
MoMo + payment integration	300,000 - 800,000
Vendor dashboard build	800,000 - 2,000,000
Legal documents	200,000 - 500,000
Marketing (3 months)	500,000 - 2,000,000
Hosting & infrastructure	100,000 - 300,000/year
Total estimate	~2.4M - 7.1M RWF

Costs can be reduced significantly by using Rwandan freelancers from platforms like RwandaJobs or Upwork.